

EMAIL HACKED

CIA Director, John Brennan's email id was hacked recently and the twenty

year old hacker was open enough to explain how he incorporated social engineering to gain access to his personal email account and compromised sensitive government files.
<http://dgit.in/CIAJBHack>

MICROSOFT'S QUIET ROOM

Microsoft's anechoic lab has entered the Guinness Book

of World Records for being the quietest room on the planet where precise audio experiments and tests are conducted for the company's speech recognition systems.
<http://dgit.in/MsftQuiet>

STATE SNOOPING

You can't be really sure whether you're

being monitored on social media, especially Facebook. To tackle this, the company will send out notifications if you're being hacked by the government.
<http://dgit.in/FbGovAl>

LICENSED DRONES

According to recent announcements from the Department of

Transportation in the US, drone owners will have to register their drones with the federal government, considering the rampant unregulated flying of drones and the ensuing legal as well as law and order issues.
<http://dgit.in/DroneReg>

the PS4 or the Xbox One, but it is great for casual gaming.

New App

Up till now, the Chromecast app sucked, but Google has changed it to become your one stop shop for streaming everything. If there is content that you are looking for or an app that is compatible with Chromecast, but you don't have the app downloaded, Google will suggest that app to you via the Chromecast app.

Google has claimed to have updated the Chromecast app with the intention of making video discovery easier. And this is true across the apps that work with Chromecast. Expect the updated Chromecast app to hit your device in the coming weeks.

Photos

Phone mirroring was an annoying feature with the original Chromecast. For example, if you wanted to see photos on your large screen TV, you would have to mirror your smartphone display and then open the photos app. Thereafter, essentially anything you did on the phone would be replicated on your TV. With the updated app, you can now interact with photos the

same way you would with YouTube. You can start streaming a video and conveniently, add videos or navigate out of YouTube. This allows you to use your phone to send messages or do anything else with your phone without affecting the video being streamed to the TV. So unless you pause or stop the casting video, it will continue to play on your big screen TV. Google has done the same thing with photos now. Now you can start a slideshow, add photos to the 'cast' library and continue to use your phone even while others enjoy your photo collection on the TV.

Chromecast Audio

The Logitech Bluetooth Audio Adapter was the only option I had to stream music to my classic speakers and it worked just fine. Google wants to cash in on this functionality and is therefore launching the Chromecast Audio. The device looks just like the new Chromecast, but instead the HDMI connector has a 3.5mm input. You can connect it to any old speaker via AUX and voila! Your good old speakers are now Wi-Fi ready! If you have friends over, they can add to your existing playlist and they can also pause or change the tracks that you are playing from the comfort of their smartphone. This can lead to annoying fights, but the availability of these options is a great addition.

Same Price

If you thought Google would raise the price of the new Chromecast you are mistaken. The Chromecast and the Chromecast Audio are both priced at \$35 each (Rs. 2,300 approx. directly converted). We think both the devices will be priced at Rs. 3,000 when they launch in India, same as the existing Chromecast (which we presume will be phased out slowly). There is no information

on the Indian launch of the new Chromecast or the Chromecast Audio but the device has launched in 17 countries now.

Will you buy the new Chromecast?

Well, if you are rocking a flat screen TV which isn't smart, or consume a lot of multimedia content on the phone then yes, the new Chromecast is definitely worth checking out. The improvements over the first generation Chromecast are significant enough to warrant an upgrade. If like me you have an awesome pair of stereo



speakers lying around then the Chromecast Audio looks like a good investment. Like we mentioned earlier, the Logitech Bluetooth Audio Adapter is also a great option for stereo speakers.

Coming back to the new Chromecast, if you own an iPhone or iPad or Mac, then the Apple TV may be a better proposition for you. Sure, the Chromecast works with iOS but you will get the "ecosystem" advantage with an Apple TV. There are a number of other HDMI based dongles available in the market that can help you stream content from your smartphone to your TV. Would you like to answer the million-dollar question for yourself this time? Will you buy the Chromecast 2? Let us know at editor@dgit.in.

